NES AI FINANCE & INSURANCE INTELLIGENCE PLATFORM

Environment Setup & Local Runbook

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Build approach: Cline-assisted development • Local-first Windows application

Scope: Personal research, paper trading and insurance document assistance

Development prerequisites, configuration and troubleshooting

1. Purpose

Reproducible setup notes for the local Windows development environment. Exact versions should be pinned in project files once the stack is chosen.

2. Development prerequisites

- Windows 10/11 with sufficient free storage and current updates.
- Git and the chosen Node.js LTS runtime/package manager.
- Python 3.11 for the planned backend, installed in an isolated virtual environment.
- Editor and Cline configured for the repository.
- Optional local AI runtime only after the base application works.
- Market data credentials only after provider terms and access are verified.

3. Environment variables

Use a local environment file that is excluded from version control. Provide a safe example file containing placeholders only. Never commit real credentials.

Variable example	Purpose
APP_ENV=development	Runtime mode.
API_BASE_URL=http://127.0.0.1:8000	Local backend URL, if applicable.
DATABASE_URL=...	Local database connection; do not commit credentials.
MARKET_PROVIDER=demo	Explicit demo adapter until provider integration is approved.
LOCAL_MODEL_URL=...	Optional local model endpoint, if configured.

4. First-run checklist

- Clone/open the repository and install dependencies using the committed lockfile.
- Create local environment file from the example.
- Run lint, type-check, tests and build.
- Start the frontend and any required local backend.
- Verify the app opens on localhost and external network exposure is not enabled by default.
- Confirm all displayed market/policy values are demo data until integrations are configured.

5. Troubleshooting

- Record the exact command and error before changing dependencies.
- Check runtime versions against the project files.
- Avoid upgrading multiple packages at once to fix one error.
- Use safe diagnostics; do not paste secrets into logs or issue reports.
- Document any environment-specific workaround.

6. Reproducibility

The README and this guide must be updated to match the actual implementation. Do not claim a command works until it has been run successfully in the target environment.